

*Complex systems exist to generate capability. The disciplines around the problem each touch part of it — LENS engineers the interface where they meet, with the human at the center of the design rather than handed off after it.*

A casebook for the Learning Design and Technology program and the Learning Engineering for Next-Generation Systems specialization at the Johns Hopkins University School of Education. One hundred real incidents — from the bridge of a U.S. Navy destroyer to a Michigan ICU to a national A-Level results algorithm — examined through the lens of capability as a system parameter.

Each case is paired with the learning-engineering insight it carries and the LENS curriculum it informs. Together they form an evidence base for the argument that capability engineering is a discipline, not an afterthought.